

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - September 9, 2026

Compiled summary for Wednesday, September 9, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio Alla Vostra project-page refinement after the September 8 Part 2 Visual Hierarchy expansion and deployment record, verifying the United States Eastern date, refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot, studying every pre-existing Portfolio PDF worklog, tightening narrow portrait Primary stack spacing, moving the Viewing Area label clear of its brace, removing gray captions from UI Foundations and UX Product Flow image groups, building UI Foundations / UX Product Flow nav mockups, implementing and iterating the two-tab section switcher treatment, renaming UI Foundations category eyebrows, renumbering UX Product Flow stages, removing the Build Proof section, regrouping technical case-study sections, studying the current Alla Vostra app repository for changed and added capabilities, updating the page around the current native commerce architecture, adding a compact architecture flow, simplifying the stack presentation, validating TypeScript and browser-rendered mobile/desktop behavior, recording the committed source state at ae7ce4b, refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot, and generating the September 9 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Prahl/portfolio work performed after `portfolio_worklog_september8_part2.pdf` and after the September 8 Part 2 documentation state. The source state reviewed for this record is `ae7ce4bf358fa59f66ee686545e085d288e9ad0f` on main, matching origin/main after the source commit titled Refreshed Alla Vostra case study around current app build. The September 9 source work is represented by commits `993c75d87646eb3fca1d321a0814368cbf53fe66` and `ae7ce4bf358fa59f66ee686545e085d288e9ad0f`. No new deployment, Hostinger synchronization, source commit, or public publish was performed during this worklog-generation pass. The local documentation deltas created by this pass are the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` file and this September 9 PDF worklog.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Verified the United States Eastern date with TZ=America/New_York date immediately before generation, which reported Wednesday, September 9, 2026 at 10:44 PM EDT. A UTC-04:00 time check during the same pass confirmed the same Eastern calendar date. The session therefore uses September 9, 2026.
- Ran `./read_project.sh` from `/Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio` and regenerated `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` before writing this worklog, preserving the project convention that Codex refreshes the current source snapshot before continuing Portfolio documentation work.
- Reviewed the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt`, including project notes, source tree, public image and PDF inventories, package and deployment configuration, current git context, generated/cache ignore policy, and the standing instruction to ask for a commit message before committing or pushing.

- Reviewed every pre-existing Portfolio root-level worklog PDF:
portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july14.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_july15_part1.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july15_part2.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_july16.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july19.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july20.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_july21.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july22.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july23.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_july24.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july25.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july29.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_july30.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july31.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august1_part1.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august1_part2.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august1_part3.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august3.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august4.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august5.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august6.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august10_part1.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august10_part2.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august11.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august12_part1.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august12_part2.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august14.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august16.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august24.pdf, portfolio_worklog_september7.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_september8.pdf, portfolio_worklog_september8_part2.pdf.
- Extracted text from all thirty-three existing Portfolio PDFs with pdftotext and checked recent metadata with pdfinfo and pdf fonts to preserve title cadence, daily and same-day part naming, opening-summary density, section order, compact bullet-heavy technical voice, validation language, files-touched lists, follow-up context, output-artifact close, root-level filename style, letter-size pages, PDF 1.4 output, Helvetica Type 1 text, and Codex author/creator/producer metadata.
- Used portfolio_worklog_september8_part2.pdf as the closest chronological and structural baseline because it documented the immediately preceding Visual Hierarchy grouped expansion, During Shopping callout work, static-export fallback, Hostinger branch update, and September 8 Part 2 documentation state.
- Reviewed git history and state through git log, git show --stat, git status --short --branch, git diff --stat, git diff --name-status, package scripts, local validation output, local route checks, and the current root-level Portfolio PDF inventory.
- Reviewed the September 9 source commits: 993c75d Refined Alla Vostra UI foundations hierarchy and navigation, and ae7ce4b Refreshed Alla Vostra case study around current app build.
- Reviewed the relevant Portfolio source files and ancillary assets:
app/projects/alla-vostra/page.tsx, app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx,
app/projects/alla-vostra/ExpandableFlowStacks.tsx,
app/projects/alla-vostra/HeroProofBottomAligner.tsx, app/globals.css,
mockups/ui-flow-nav-alternatives.png, package.json, read_project.sh, and the local /projects/alla-vostra route.
- Cross-checked the current Alla Vostra app repository at /Users/prahlin/gh/alla_vostra, including mob/package.json, mob/app.json, mob/app.config.js, mob/eas.json, mob/app/_layout.js, mob/app/shop.js, mob/app/contact.js, mob/utills/stripePayments.js, mob/utills/stripeNative.js, mob/utills/paypalPayments.js, mob/utills/contactMessages.js, server/README.md, server/lib/orders.js, server/api/payment-sheet.js, server/api/paypal-create-order.js, server/api/paypal-capture-order.js, server/api/contact-message.js, and the current app/web project snapshots.

Baseline Status Before September 9 Work

- September 8 Part 2 left the Alla Vostra Visual Hierarchy section with grouped Pre-Scrolling, On-Scrolling, and During Shopping rows, expanded focal braces, product-overlay callout pins, row-level Show More / Show Less behavior, and a deployed Hostinger static-export fallback.

- The Primary Visual Hierarchy stacks in narrow portrait views still had more horizontal space than the user wanted between brace/device, device/white-line, and white-line/green-header asset pairs. The accepted requirement was to halve those gaps while keeping the primary stacks centered and avoiding clipping on narrow smartphone portrait views.
- The Viewing Area label clipped its brace after the spacing reduction, then needed two incremental left nudges totaling seven pixels while remaining visually attached to the brace system.
- UI Foundations still carried gray caption text beneath images in Categories 00 through 04 even after the user decided those captions weakened the screen. Category 05 was intentionally excluded from the removal request.
- UX Product Flow stages 00 through 05 still showed gray captions beneath their stage images and used stage numbering that the user wanted bumped forward to Stage 01 through Stage 06.
- The UI Foundations / UX Product Flow two-button nav needed a calmer active/inactive hierarchy. Early active green stroke and inactive white surface treatments made the nav feel heavier than the section content, especially over the dark grid-pattern page background.
- The nav appeared while scrolling down to the section but could linger past the bottom of the product-flow region. The accepted behavior was to keep it scoped to the section: visible while the product-flow block is active, absent once the bottom is passed, and visible again when upward scrolling returns to the block.
- The Alla Vostra case-study back half had become cluttered with separate Scope, Core Features, Technical Architecture, Engineering Decisions, Testing and Release Readiness, Build Timeline, Stack, and Build Proof sections. Some information overlapped, especially Build Proof versus hero proof stats and stack/release content.
- After the current Alla Vostra app repository audit, the project page under-described the latest build. It still read mostly as a Stripe and Android release-prep story, while the app had grown into a native commerce system with Stripe card checkout, Google Pay, Apple Pay, PayPal, server-side order authority, contact routing, Postmark messaging, EAS profiles, TestFlight config, and Android versioned release preparation.

Goals for September 9

- Verify the active United States Eastern date and produce the next root-level Portfolio PDF worklog using the established naming convention.
- Refresh and review the Portfolio project snapshot before writing the PDF, then preserve the same worklog structure, metadata, and PDF style used by the mature Portfolio records.
- Tighten the Primary Visual Hierarchy horizontal asset gaps across Pre-Scrolling, On-Scrolling, and During Shopping in narrow portrait views without de-centering the primary stacks or clipping the annotation lanes.
- Remove unwanted gray captions from UI Foundations Categories 00 through 04 and UX Product Flow stages while preserving the specifically excluded Category 05 captions.
- Generate and apply a calmer UI Foundations / UX Product Flow nav treatment that clearly marks the active section without overwhelming the inactive option.
- Scope the product-flow nav sticky behavior to the actual UI Foundations / UX Product Flow region so it drops away after the section is passed and returns when the user scrolls back into it.
- Remove the redundant Build Proof section and simplify the technical case-study back half by merging architecture with stack, and engineering decisions with release readiness and timeline.

- Study the current Alla Vostra application and backend repos, then update the project page so non-flow sections reflect current stack, architecture, payment rails, backend validation, messaging, contact routing, native testing, and release preparation.
- Validate the final page with TypeScript, local route checks, Playwright desktop/mobile layout checks, and diff/status review before generating the PDF worklog.

Work Completed - Visual Hierarchy, Captions, and Flow Navigation

- Halved the horizontal gaps between the Pre-Scrolling Primary brace and device frame, device frame and white lines, and white lines and green headers, then extrapolated those spacing values across the On-Scrolling and During Shopping Primary stacks for narrow portrait views.
- Kept the Primary stacks horizontally centered after reducing the asset-pair gaps, preserving the centered composition while making the annotation lanes fit more comfortably on narrow smartphone layouts.
- Moved the Viewing Area text with the brace repositioning, then nudged the label left by five pixels and two more pixels after user review so it no longer clipped into the brace.
- Removed grayish image captions from the UI Foundations screen between Category 00 and Category 04, including examples such as visibility-state notes and font-sample captions, while leaving Category 05 untouched.
- Added showCaptions support to ExpandableFlowStacks and used it to remove gray captions from UX Product Flow stages without deleting the underlying screen metadata.
- Bumped UX Product Flow stage labels forward from Stage 00 through Stage 05 to Stage 01 through Stage 06.
- Renamed the green eyebrow headers for UI Foundations Category 00 through Category 05 to UI FOUNDATIONS so the UI Foundations screen reads consistently across its subsections.
- Created three mockups of alternative UI Foundations / UX Product Flow two-button nav treatments and committed mockups/ui-flow-nav-alternatives.png as the visual reference artifact.
- Implemented the preferred nav treatment, matched the active green styling to the established eyebrow color, made the inactive tab transparent so the page grid shows through, and removed the active eyebrow-colored stroke after user review.
- Updated ProductFlowSwitcher sticky logic so the nav is section-scoped: it appears while the product-flow section is active, leaves once the section bottom is passed, and reappears when upward scrolling returns to the section.

Work Completed - Section Pruning, Proof Scaling, and Technical Reorganization

- Removed the standalone Build Proof section after the user chose to reduce repeated proof content in the lower half of the Alla Vostra page.
- Merged Technical Architecture and Stack into Architecture and Stack, preserving the source data arrays in a reversible content-driven shape while reducing section count.
- Merged Engineering Decisions, Testing and Release Readiness, and Build Timeline into Build Execution, then restored breathing room between the new subsections after the first combined layout felt too compressed.
- Adjusted the hero proof-stat number scaling so green values continue growing with wider viewports and fit their columns when the hero shifts from one visible phone frame to three device frames.
- Shortened long Release Readiness chips into scan-friendly labels such as Android v1.0.3, EAS Build Profiles, Stripe Live + Webhooks, Native Wallet Checks, PayPal Sandbox/Live, Postmark Messaging, and Play Store AAB.

- Renamed Store Front Releases to Storefront Releases, keeping the proof label sharper and more conventional without changing the underlying count.
- Added CSS containment and wrapping safeguards for the longer technical chips and combined grid wrappers so the updated technical content does not create horizontal overflow on phone-width layouts.

Work Completed - Current App Repo Audit and Case Study Refresh

- Studied the current Alla Vostra app repo after the user noted significant changes since the page was initially generated, focusing on removed, changed, and newly added features, stack, architecture, and functionality.
- Confirmed the current mobile stack in mob/package.json and app config: Expo 54, React Native 0.81.5, React 19.1, Expo Router 6, Stripe React Native 0.50.3, Expo Dev Client, Reanimated 4, Worklets, Safe Area Context, Expo Linking, Expo Navigation Bar, and related native support packages.
- Confirmed current native release configuration in mob/app.json, mob/app.config.js, and mob/eas.json, including Android package com.allavostra.app, version 1.0.3, versionCode 4, Play Store AAB profiles, TestFlight configuration, development-client setup, and free-account Apple Pay entitlement disable flags for dev builds.
- Confirmed backend routes and responsibilities in server/README.md and server/api files: health checks, Stripe payment sheet creation, PayPal order create/capture, Stripe webhook handling, contact-message delivery, Postmark confirmations, environment variables, and server-owned pricing.
- Confirmed server-side commerce authority in server/lib/orders.js: catalog prices, delivery fee, tax calculation, quantity validation, contact and delivery payload sanitization, and Florida-only delivery acceptance.
- Confirmed mobile checkout behavior in mob/app/shop.js and payment utilities: card entry, Google Pay, Apple Pay, PayPal redirect/capture, selected-payment validation, platform availability checks, Expo Go native-payment guardrails, billing details, order payload creation, and order confirmation state.
- Confirmed the Contact screen and contact-message utility now support a real customer inquiry path through the backend and Postmark rather than static contact-only copy.
- Updated Alla Vostra project-page metadata, overview, scope, ownership, core features, architecture, stack, engineering decisions, release readiness, timeline, and closing copy to match the current native commerce system.
- Added a compact Architecture Flow row showing Mobile App -> Vercel API -> Payment Rails -> Messaging -> Store Builds, giving the technical section a clearer system story before the supporting architecture cards.
- Simplified the detailed architecture and stack presentation into five architecture cards and five stack groups, reducing dependency-inventory noise while retaining the strongest full-stack proof points.
- Left the hero platform proof unchanged after the user explicitly asked to skip the platform-overclaim recommendation for this pass.

Validation and Review

- Ran npm run check after the technical content updates, caption changes, flow navigation updates, and final architecture-flow pass; TypeScript completed successfully with tsc --noEmit.
- Checked the local Alla Vostra project route with curl -I and confirmed HTTP 200 responses from http://127.0.0.1:3000/projects/alla-vostra during the validation passes.

- Used Playwright against the local Next.js site at desktop and phone viewports to inspect console errors, page title, body scroll width, architecture-flow count, architecture-node count, stack-group count, and element bounds.
- Confirmed the final Playwright desktop and phone passes reported no console errors, no body-level horizontal overflow, no out-of-bounds metadata/readiness/stack/architecture/card elements, five architecture flow steps, five architecture nodes, and five stack groups.
- Restarted the local Next.js development server after a stale port-3000 Next process was found, then confirmed the clean detached portfolio-dev session returned the Alla Vostra route successfully.
- Captured temporary architecture screenshots for desktop and phone inspection during the hierarchy pass, used them to detect overly skinny desktop technical cards, then removed the temporary PNGs from the worktree before closing validation.
- Used rg checks to confirm older stale phrases such as Stripe payments, Node.js backend, Android QA + release prep, Technical Architecture, Build Proof, 333 commits, and old Core Feature titles were removed from app/projects/alla-vostra/page.tsx.
- Reviewed git diff and git status before this PDF generation. The source changes were already committed to main and origin/main at ae7ce4b, and the only local pre-PDF delta was the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt file.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/projects/alla-vostra/page.tsx - updated hero metadata, overview copy, scope and ownership cards, Core Features, architecture data, architecture-flow rendering, decision items, release readiness chips, timeline items, stack groups, Build Proof removal, stage numbering, caption flags, and closing copy.
- app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx - refined UI Foundations / UX Product Flow nav styling behavior, section-scoped sticky behavior, Primary Visual Hierarchy spacing, category eyebrow naming, UX stage numbering, and caption suppression wiring.
- app/projects/alla-vostra/ExpandableFlowStacks.tsx - added showCaptions support so product-flow screen captions can be hidden without stripping screen data.
- app/globals.css - added responsive proof-stat scaling, transparent/inactive nav and active-tab refinements, Visual Hierarchy spacing guards, combined-section spacing, architecture-flow styles, scoped architecture/stack column rules, mobile overflow protection, and readiness-chip wrapping.
- mockups/ui-flow-nav-alternatives.png - added the requested three-option nav mockup reference for the UI Foundations / UX Product Flow switcher.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - regenerated with ./read_project.sh during the documentation pass so the repository snapshot reflects the current Portfolio workspace state.
- portfolio_worklog_september9.pdf - added this latest September 9, 2026 Portfolio worklog artifact.

Follow-Up Context

- The current source work has been committed in 993c75d and ae7ce4b, making the recent UI Foundations navigation changes and broader Alla Vostra technical-story refresh easy to inspect or reverse by commit if the user asks.
- The local dev server is available again through the detached portfolio-dev session on port 3000 after cleaning up the stale Next process encountered during validation.

- The Build Proof removal, section merging, stack simplification, and architecture-flow addition were intentionally kept content/layout-scoped so they can be reverted without touching unrelated portfolio pages.
- The hero platform proof was intentionally not changed in this pass, per the user direction to apply all portfolio best-practice recommendations except the platform-overclaim item.
- A possible next review pass would be to decide whether the Architecture and Stack section should gain a visual diagram or remain text-only, now that the compact flow row carries the system story without adding another screenshot-heavy section.

Output Artifact

- Created portfolio_worklog_september9.pdf at the repository root using the verified United States Eastern date, root-level naming convention, established Portfolio worklog structure, letter-size PDF pages, Helvetica Type 1 fonts, and Codex author/creator/producer metadata.
- This worklog closes the September 9 documentation pass. No source commit, push, deployment, or Hostinger synchronization was performed as part of generating the PDF.